MERCY'S ANATOMY

Document MA-003: Series Order & Season Structure

Revision A. Canon Lock v1.3. Supersedes MA-003 (v1.2). Amends MA-001 Rule 2 and Sections 3, 8 and 12; amends MA-002 Section 4

STATUS: LOCKED IN (REVISION A). Episode counts for Seasons 7, 11 and 15 have been corrected to match *Grey's Anatomy*. The story start date is fixed at **Friday, July 1, 2005**. *Mercy's Anatomy* is an **ongoing** series running from **2005 to the present**. **22 seasons** are ordered, for a total of **466 episodes**. Every episode corresponds one-to-one with its *Grey's Anatomy* counterpart (see §2, Equivalence Standard).

1. Official Season Order

Szn	Eps	Running total	In-story span	Hospital name	Academic year / class
1	9	1-9	Jul 1, 2005 - late summer 2005	Queens Grace	AY 2005-06: Interns (PGY-1)
2	27	10-36	2005-06	Queens Grace	AY 2005-06: Interns (PGY-1)
3	25	37-61	2006-07	Queens Grace	AY 2006-07
4	17	62-78	2007-08	Queens Grace	AY 2007-08
5	24	79-102	2008-09	Queens Grace	AY 2008-09
6	24	103-126	2009-10	Queens Grace → QG Hudson Mercy	AY 2009-10
7	22	127-148	2010-11	QG Hudson Mercy	AY 2010-11
8	24	149-172	2011-12	QG Hudson Mercy	AY 2011-12
9	24	173-196	2012-13	QG Hudson Mercy → Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2012-13
10	24	197-220	2013-14	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2013-14
11	25	221-245	2014-15	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2014-15
12	24	246-269	2015-16	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2015-16

Szn	Eps	Running total	In-story span	Hospital name	Academic year / class
13	24	270-293	2016-17	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2016-17
14	24	294-317	2017-18	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2017-18
15	25	318-342	2018-19	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2018-19
16	21	343-363	2019-20	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2019-20
17	17	364-380	2020-21	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2020-21
18	20	381-400	2021-22	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2021-22
19	20	401-420	2022-23	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2022-23
20	10	421-430	Spring 2024	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2023-24
21	18	431-448	2024-25	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2024-25
22	18	449-466	2025-26	Bullock Sloan Memorial	AY 2025-26
ALL	**466**		2005-2026		

*Episode counts match Grey's Anatomy season for season. In-story spans: the story opens on **Friday, July 1, 2005**, the first day of the intern year, and Season 1 covers the opening weeks of that year. From Season 2 on, each season occupies the same stretch of the calendar as its Grey's Anatomy counterpart, with summer gaps. Exact episode dates are set when episodes are built. Class levels after the intern year depend on the graduation-timing ruling in §3.*

2. The Equivalence Standard

Ruling: every *Mercy's Anatomy* episode is the exact equivalent of the same-numbered *Grey's Anatomy* episode (S1E1 = S1E1, through S22E18), down to the minute detail, but with **our characters**.

What matches 1:1 (equivalent)	What is ours (original)
Episode order and count per season	All character names, faces, backstories and birthdays
Story beats, twists and the order of events	All dialogue, which is written fresh in screenplay format
Which kind of character gets which arc (for example, the counterpart of each death, romance, departure or promotion)	Patient names, and the specific case wording and details
Event placement: disasters, crises, finales and cliffhangers	Queens / Long Island City setting, real 2005-2026 NYC locations
Season mythology arcs and their payoffs	The Queens Grace → Hudson Mercy → Bullock Sloan history
Act structure and where the surgery falls	News articles, social media and internet content
Relative timing (e.g. a midseason event stays midseason)	Episode titles

Writing rule: episodes are *equivalent*, not transcribed. No *Grey's Anatomy* dialogue, script text or narration is copied. Every line is written new for our characters, in our setting and in our voice. That keeps MA-001 Rule 2 (original) and this standard both true at the same time.

No-Nerf clause: where a Grey's counterpart arc would shrink a character, our version keeps the same story event, but the cause has to be earned, without reducing the character's established skill or strength (MA-001 Rule 9).

3. Calendar Notes for Continuity

- **THE STORY STARTS FRIDAY, JULY 1, 2005**, the first day of the intern year at Queens Grace Hospital. S1E1 takes place on that date.
- **Seasons 1 and 2 share one academic year (AY 2005-06).** The interns are PGY-1 throughout both. The first July 1 turnover (Saturday, July 1, 2006) falls between Season 2 and Season 3.
- **PENDING CREATOR RULING, graduation timing:** with a standard 5-year program on a real calendar, the original class finishes in **June 2010** (end of Season 6). Their Grey's counterparts finish at the end of **Season 8 (June 2012)**. Class levels for Season 3 onward stay unlocked until the creator rules on this.
- **Season 2 (27 episodes)** is the longest season. It runs from fall 2005 to spring 2006, still inside the intern year.
- **Seasons 4 (17), 17 (17) and 20 (10)** are shortened seasons. Their in-story spans may be compressed, and dates must still add up.
- **Season 17 spans 2020-21.** Under MA-001 §8 (real-world context is honored), the COVID-19 pandemic is part of the in-story world for that period, as it is for its counterpart.
- **Season 20 runs in spring 2024 only**, which leaves a longer in-story gap after Season 19 to account for.
- **Every later July 1 residency turnover** falls in the summer gap between seasons, so class promotions (MA-002 §4) happen off-screen between finales and premieres.
- **Ages:** because the series spans 21+ in-story years, every character's age is recalculated for every dated scene. A character who is 26 in 2005 is 46-47 by 2026.

4. Amendments

Document / section	Change
MA-001 Rule 2	Expanded to cover one-to-one episode equivalence to Grey's Anatomy, with original characters and dialogue (MA-003 §2).
MA-001 §3 Season length	Was 'reserved'. Now set: 22 seasons, with counts per MA-003 §1.
MA-001 §8 / §12	Story start date: **Friday, July 1, 2005**. Season counts and episode orders are filled. Day-by-day episode dates are still reserved.
MA-003 (v1.2)	Superseded. S7 changes from 24 to 22, S11 from 24 to 25, and S15 from 15 to 25 (creator typos corrected). Total changes from 457 to 466.

Document / section	Change
MA-002 §4	The default table in MA-002 ('Season 2 = PGY-2', etc.) is **withdrawn**. Seasons 1-2 = PGY-1. Levels from Season 3 on are pending the graduation-timing ruling (MA-003 §3).

5. Canon Log Additions

ID	Established fact	Source
C-008	The series is ongoing, running 2005-present. 22 seasons are ordered.	MA-003
C-009	Episode counts per season as listed, for a total of 466.	MA-003 §1
C-010	Each episode is the one-to-one equivalent of the same-numbered Grey's Anatomy episode, with original characters and dialogue.	MA-003 §2
C-011	From Season 2, each season's in-story span mirrors its counterpart's calendar window.	MA-003 §1
C-012	The story begins Friday, July 1, 2005, the first day of the intern year. S1E1 takes place on that date.	MA-003 §3
C-013	Seasons 1-2 = AY 2005-06. The original class are interns (PGY-1) throughout.	MA-003 §3

END OF MA-003. CANON LOCKED (v1.3, REV. A).
466 episodes on the board. Next: the cast.